

CONFUSE

1. Passage anchor

> “If the whole class looked **confused**, she could read the room instantly and change her approach on the spot.”

Passage meaning

confused = unable to understand something clearly; uncertain about what something means or what to do

困惑的；搞不清楚的；不知所措的

Here, the students do not understand the physics explanation.

Practice

1. The students looked **confused**, so she explained the idea again.

學生看起來很**困惑**，所以她又解釋了一次。

2. I felt **confused** until she gave us a simple example.

在她舉出簡單例子之前，我一直覺得很**搞不懂**。

Core meanings of CONFUSE

2. confuse — make someone unable to understand clearly

= make someone uncertain or unable to think clearly about something

使困惑；把某人弄糊塗

Examples

1. The instructions **confused me**.

這些說明把我**弄糊塗了**。

2. Too many technical terms can **confuse beginners**.

太多技術術語可能會**使初學者困惑**。

This is the central verb meaning.

3. confuse someone

= cause a particular person to become confused

****使某人困惑****

Examples

1. The final step ****confused several students****.

最後一步讓幾名學生感到****困惑****。

2. His explanation ****confused me even more****.

他的解釋反而讓我****更糊塗****。

Mix up one thing with another

4. confuse A with B

= wrongly think that A is B, or fail to distinguish between them

****把 A 和 B 搞混；誤認****

Examples

1. Students often ****confuse mass with weight****.

學生常把質量和重量****搞混****。

2. Don't ****confuse confidence with arrogance****.

不要把自信和傲慢****混為一談****。

This is a major distinct use.

5. confuse two people / things

= mistake one person or thing for another

****把兩者認錯；混淆****

Examples

1. I always ****confuse the two brothers****.

我總是****分不清這兩兄弟****。

2. People sometimes ****confuse these two terms****.

人們有時會****混淆這兩個術語****。

Make less clear / blur distinctions

6. confuse the issue

= make a situation or discussion less clear by adding irrelevant or misleading information

****把問題弄得更複雜；混淆焦點****

Examples

1. Bringing up unrelated details only ****confuses the issue****.
提起無關細節只會****混淆焦點****。
2. The extra argument ****confused the issue**** rather than solving it.
額外的爭論沒有解決問題，反而****把事情弄得更亂****。

7. confuse matters

= make a situation harder to understand or deal with

****把事情弄得更複雜 / 更亂****

Examples

1. A second set of instructions only ****confused matters****.
第二套說明只會****把事情弄得更亂****。
2. Changing the rules halfway through ****confused matters further****.
中途改規則讓情況****更加混亂****。

Adjective: confused

8. confused — unable to understand clearly

= not understanding something clearly

****困惑的；糊塗的****

This is the exact passage form.

Examples

1. I'm ****confused**** about this formula.
我對這條公式感到****困惑****。

2. She looked ****confused**** by the question.

她似乎被那個問題****弄糊塗了****。

9. confused about something

= uncertain because you do not understand something

****對.....感到困惑****

Examples

1. I'm ****confused about the difference**** between the two terms.

我對這兩個術語的差別感到****困惑****。

2. Students were ****confused about what to do next****.

學生****搞不清楚下一步該做甚麼****。

10. confused by something

= made uncertain or unclear by something

****被.....弄糊塗****

Examples

1. She was ****confused by the instructions****.

她被那些說明****弄糊塗了****。

2. I was ****confused by his answer****.

我被他的回答****搞得很困惑****。

Mental disorientation

11. confused — mentally disoriented

= unable to think clearly, especially because of illness, shock, tiredness, or unfamiliar surroundings

****神志不清的；意識混亂的****

Examples

1. He seemed ****confused**** after waking up.

他醒來後似乎有點**神志不清**。

2. The patient became increasingly **confused**.

病人的**意識混亂**情況愈來愈明顯。

This is distinct from simply not understanding a lesson.

Disorganized / unclear situation

12. confused — lacking clear organization

= badly organized or difficult to follow

混亂的；條理不清的

Examples

1. His argument was rather **confused**.

他的論點相當**混亂**。

2. The report gives a **confused account** of what happened.

這份報告對事件的描述**條理不清**。

Here **confused** describes the thing itself as disorderly, not a person's feeling.

Adjective: confusing

13. confusing — causing confusion

= difficult to understand because it is unclear, complicated, or badly explained

令人困惑的；讓人搞不懂的

Examples

1. The instructions were **confusing**.

這些說明很**令人困惑**。

2. The diagram is more **confusing** than helpful.

這張圖與其說有幫助，不如說更**讓人看不懂**。

14. confused vs confusing

This distinction is essential.

****confused****

= how a person feels

****感到困惑的****

****confusing****

= what causes the confusion

****令人困惑的****

Compare:

> I am ****confused****.

> 我感到困惑。

> The explanation is ****confusing****.

> 這個解釋令人困惑。

Noun forms

15. confusion

A. lack of understanding

****困惑；不解****

1. The instructions caused a lot of ****confusion****.

這些說明造成了很多****困惑****。

B. disorder / chaos

****混亂****

2. There was complete ****confusion**** after the announcement.

公告之後現場一片****混亂****。

C. mistaken identity or mixing

****混淆；誤認****

3. The similar names led to ****confusion****.

相似的名字造成了****混淆****。

16. cause confusion

= make people uncertain, unclear, or mixed up

****造成困惑 / 混亂****

Examples

1. The new rule caused ****confusion**** among students.

新規則在學生之間造成了****困惑****。

2. Similar labels can cause ****confusion****.

相似的標籤可能造成****混淆****。

17. avoid confusion

= prevent misunderstanding or uncertainty

****避免混淆；避免困惑****

Examples

1. Use clear labels to ****avoid confusion****.

使用清楚的標籤來****避免混淆****。

2. Let me explain the difference to ****avoid confusion****.

讓我解釋一下差別，以****避免誤解****。

Related form

18. confusingly

= in a way that makes something difficult to understand

****令人困惑地；混亂地****

Examples

1. The two options are ****confusingly similar****.

這兩個選項相似得****很容易讓人混淆****。

2. The instructions are ****confusingly written****.

這些說明寫得****很難理解****。

High-value expressions

19. get confused

= become confused

開始搞不清楚；弄糊塗

Examples

1. I always **get confused** at this step.
我每次到這一步都會**搞混**。
2. Students may **get confused** if too many ideas are introduced at once.
如果一次加入太多概念，學生可能會**感到困惑**。

20. easily confused

= likely to become confused or be mistaken for something else

容易搞混的；容易被混淆的

Examples

1. The two symbols are **easily confused**.
這兩個符號很**容易被混淆**。
2. Beginners are **easily confused by similar terms**.
初學者很容易被相似術語**弄糊塗**。

21. hopelessly / completely confused

= extremely confused

完全搞不清楚；非常困惑

Examples

1. By the end, I was **completely confused**.
到最後我已經**完全搞不清楚了**。
2. He looked **hopelessly confused**.

他看起來**完全一頭霧水**。

Key contrasts

22. confuse vs misunderstand

****confuse****

= make someone uncertain, or mix two things up

****使困惑；混淆****

****misunderstand****

= interpret someone's words, intention, or situation incorrectly

****誤解****

Compare:

> The terminology ****confused me****.

> 術語把我弄糊塗了。

> I ****misunderstood what she meant****.

> 我誤解了她的意思。

23. confuse vs puzzle

****puzzle****

= cause someone to wonder because something is difficult to explain

****使疑惑；使費解****

****confuse****

= broader; make someone unable to understand clearly

Compare:

> The result ****puzzled**** the researchers.

> 結果讓研究人員很疑惑。

> The instructions ****confused**** the students.

> 說明把學生弄糊塗了。

24. confuse vs bewilder

****bewilder****

= confuse someone very strongly

****使非常困惑；使茫然****

Compare:

> The explanation confused me.

> 解釋讓我困惑。

> The sudden changes completely ****bewildered me****.

> 突然的變化讓我****完全不知所措****。

****Bewilder**** is stronger.

25. confuse vs mix up

****mix up****

= informal way of saying confuse one thing/person with another

****搞混；弄錯****

Compare:

> I ****confused**** the two formulas.

> 我把兩條公式搞混了。

> I ****mixed up**** the two formulas.

> 我把兩條公式搞混了。

****Mix up**** is more conversational.

26. confused vs lost

****confused****

= unable to understand clearly

****lost****

= not knowing what to do or how to proceed

****不知所措****

Compare:

> I'm **confused** about the formula.

> 我不明白公式。

> I'm completely **lost** in this lesson.

> 這堂課我完全跟不上、不知所措。

There is overlap, but **lost** often suggests a greater lack of direction.

Meaning map

The central concept of **confuse** is:

make distinctions or understanding unclear

From this develop:

Understanding

confuse someone

→ **使某人困惑**

Mistaken identity

confuse A with B

→ **把 A 和 B 搞混**

Discussion

confuse the issue

→ **混淆焦點**

Feeling

confused

→ **感到困惑**

Cause

confusing

→ **令人困惑**

Mental disorientation

confused patient

→ **神志混亂**

Noun

confusion

→ **困惑 / 混亂 / 混淆**

The passage uses the learning/understanding branch:

students cannot make sense of the explanation

→ **they look confused**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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confuse someone	使某人無法清楚理解或判斷；使困惑
confuse A with B	錯把 A 當成 B，或無法清楚區分兩者；搞混
confuse two things/people	把兩個人或事物認錯 / 混淆
confuse the issue	加入無關或不清楚的資訊，使問題焦點更模糊
confuse matters	使事情變得更複雜、更難理解或處理
confused — understanding	因不了解情況、內容或下一步而感到困惑
confused about	對某件事的意思、差別或做法搞不清楚
confused by	因某項資訊、說明或情況而被弄糊塗
confused — mental state	因疾病、疲勞、震驚等而神志或思緒混亂
confused — disorganized	內容或結構缺乏條理、讓人難以跟隨
confusing	本身會使人難以理解；令人困惑的
confusion — lack of understanding	因資訊不清而產生的困惑 / 不解
confusion — disorder	場面、安排或情況缺乏秩序；混亂
confusion — mistaken mixing	無法分清兩件事而造成的混淆 / 誤認
cause confusion	使人困惑、誤解或造成混亂
avoid confusion	避免產生誤解、混淆或不清楚
get confused	開始感到困惑或把事情搞混
easily confused	很容易被誤認、混淆，或容易感到困惑

Passage recap

> “If the whole class looked **confused**, she could read the room instantly...”

Here:

confused = **unable to understand clearly**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **困惑的**

* **搞不清楚的**

* **一頭霧水的**

Natural contextual translation:

如果全班看起來一頭霧水，她幾乎可以立刻察覺。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

confused

= **unable to understand something clearly or know what to do next**

困惑的；搞不清楚的

The essential contrast is:

> **The students were confused.**

> → 學生感到困惑。

> **The explanation was confusing.**

> → 那個解釋令人困惑。

And:

> **Don't confuse mass with weight.**

> → 不要把質量和重量搞混。

These are the three highest-value branches for learners.